Lesson 22 material: Pronunciation: Voiced and Unvoiced Consonants

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 2: Getting to Know You

2.6: Voiced and Unvoiced Consonants

From *Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level* by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Brittany Zemlick.
Original page, with audio and online exercises:
https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/Book%3A_Speaking_Listening_and_Pronunciation_Projects_for_ELLs_-_Intermediate_Level_(Zemlick)/02%3A_Getting_to_Know_You/2.06%3A_Voiced_and_Unvoiced_Consonants
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Audio for this section is saved on your computer in `E:\personal-tutor\materials\library\esl-b1-speaking\attachments\02.06-voiced-and-unvoiced-consonants`: Practice - Long or Show Vowel Sound? ; Rules to Remember 1; Voiced or unvoiced - choose the corrects reply

Watch the Video

Accent Diet

Video: https://youtu.be/sJ4lGwE3ja8

Phonemic Chart

Review the consonant sounds on the Phonemic Chart or the Interactive American IPA Chart. Which sounds are voiced and which sounds are unvoiced?

Practice

Are the Consonants Voiced or Unvoiced?

Which of these sounds is voiced and which is unvoiced? Write "voiced" or "unvoiced" on the line.

EXAMPLE: The "th" in "thumb." unvoiced

1. The "th" in "mother." _____
2. The "b" in "bag." _____
3. The "p" in "pack." _____
4. The "d" in "ride." _____
5. The "t" in "right." _____
6. The "ng" in "singing." _____
7. The "y" in "yacht." _____
8. The "s" in "sea." _____
9. The "z" in "zoo." _____
10. The "l" in "let." _____
11. The "r" in "read." _____
12. The "h" in "home." _____

Rules to Remember 1

Listen to each word pair. How are the vowel sounds different in these word pairs? (Audio on the lesson web page: "Rules to Remember 1")

The final consonant sound is unvoiced.	The final consonant sound is voiced.
rope	robe
coat	code
pick	pig
leaf	leave
price	prize

Rule

Vowels before final voiced consonants sound **longer** than vowels before unvoiced consonants.

Rules to Remember 2

Read each of these words out loud. Put your hand on your throat. Do you feel a vibration when you say the final sound of each word? Are the final sounds voiced or unvoiced?

- play
- go
- die
- knee

Rule

All the words above end with a vowel sound. **Vowel sounds** are always **voiced.**

Practice

Long or Short Vowel Sound?

Do you hear a long or short vowel sound? Circle the word you hear. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Practice - Long or Show Vowel Sound")

1. lap / lab
2. seat / seed
3. coat / code
4. rack / rag
5. buck / bug
6. tack / tag
7. leaf / leave
8. proof / prove
9. peace / peas
10. price / prize

AnswerS - Practice - Long or Short Vowel Sound?.docx

Choose the correct reply

Listen to the speaker say sentence a or b. Put an X next to the correct reply. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Voiced or unvoiced - choose the corrects reply")

Number	Listen. Do you hear sentence a or b?	Put an X next to the correct reply.		
1	a. Did you see the price?	b. Did you see the prize?	_____ Yes! It's very expensive!	_____ Yes! Congratulations on winning!
2	a. He gave me a buck!	b. He gave me a bug!	_____ He gave you a dollar? Why?	_____ He gave you an insect? Why?
3	a. We need peace.	b. We need peas.	_____ Yes. War is bad for everyone.	_____ Ok. I will go to the store.
4	a. Can you get me a rack?	b. Can you get me a rag?	_____ Do you want something to hang clothes on?	_____ Why? Do you need to clean something?
5	a. Get him a seat.	b. Get him a seed.	_____ Does he need to sit down?	_____ What is he planting? Fruit or vegetables?
6	a. He bought a pick.	b. He bought a pig.	_____ Does he play the guitar?	_____ Why did he buy an animal?

AnswerS - Choose the correct reply.docx

Check

Check your answers with the class. Then listen and repeat both sentences and replies.

Picture Dictionary

Do you know these words? Work with a partner to match the words with the pictures.

- pick
- rag
- rack
- seed

(Picture: an orange guitar pick and guitar strings) (Picture: a hand cleaning the hood of car with a yellow rag) (Picture: two hands holding small, round, black seeds) (Picture: a clothes rack with hangers and clothes hanging on it)

Figure: Photos by MAYANK D on Unsplash, Matthew Dockery on Unsplash, Photo by Joshua Lanzarini on Unsplash, and Photo by Artificial Photography on Unsplash

Practice Speaking

Work with a partner. Look again at each sentence. Student a, say sentence a or b. Student b, say the correct reply. Then switch roles.

Notice Sounds in Real-World English

Watch the video of Andy's interview. Remember to click the CC button so you can read the subtitles. Find at least 3 words with an unvoiced consonant ending and 3 words with a voiced consonant ending. Write them in the table below.

Video: https://youtu.be/Wa0582oOYgY

Voiced Consonant Ending	Unvoiced Consonant Ending
Example: na<u>m</u>e	Example: as<u>k</u>

More Practice 1: Voiced or Unvoiced?

Are the final sounds of each word voiced or unvoiced?

EXERCISE

1. The final consonant of the word "brother" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

2. The final consonant of the word "farm" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

3. The final consonant of the word "vegan" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

4. The final consonant of the word "habitat" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

5. The final consonant of the word "practice" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

6. The final consonant of the word "pick" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

7. The final consonant of the word "office" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

8. The final consonant of the word "want" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

9. The final sound of the word "go" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

10. The final sound of the word "play" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

11. The final consonant of the word "avoid" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

12. The final consonant of the word "weed" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

13. The final consonant of the word "water" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

14. The final consonant of the word "repair" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

15. The final consonant of the word "hurt" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

16. The final consonant of the word "listen" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

17. The final consonant of the word "vegetable" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

18. The final consonant of the word "work" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

19. The final consonant of the word "cook" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

20. The final consonant of the word "drive" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

21. The final consonant of the word "pull" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

22. The final consonant of the word "podcast" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

More Practice 2: Voiced or Unvoiced?

Are the final consonants of each word voiced or unvoiced?

EXERCISE

1. The final consonant of the word "lap" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

2. The final consonant of the word "etch" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

3. The final consonant of the word "lab" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

4. The final consonant of the word "rag" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

5. The final consonant of the word "seat" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

6. The final consonant of the word "seed" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

7. The final consonant of the word "rack" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

8. The final consonant of the word "cab" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

9. The final consonant of the word "back" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

10. The final consonant of the word "edge" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

11. The final consonant of the word "bag" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

12. The final consonant of the word "cap" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

13. The final consonant of the word "leaf" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

14. The final consonant of the word "art" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

15. The final consonant of the word "brother" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

16. The final consonant of the word "turn" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

17. The final consonant of the word "exude" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

18. The final consonant of the word "park" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

19. The final consonant of the word "divide" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

20. The final consonant of the word "divice" is . . .
a) voiced b) unvoiced

Recording: Voiced and Unvoiced Consonants

Read each of the sentences below. Remember to make the vowel sound before a voiced consonant long and clear. Make the vowel before an unvoiced consonant shorter.

_____ / 12 points

1. a. Did you see the price?
    - b. Did you see the prize?
2. a. He gave me a buck!
    - b. He gave me a bug!
3. a. We need peace.
    - b. We need peas.
4. a. Can you get me a rack?
    - b. Can you get me a rag?
5. a. Get him a seat.
    - b. Get him a seed.
6. a. He bought a pick.
    - b. He bought a pig.

Links on the original page

- Phonemic Chart: http://learnteachtravel.com/wp-content/uploads/2017/02/us-768x559.jpg